

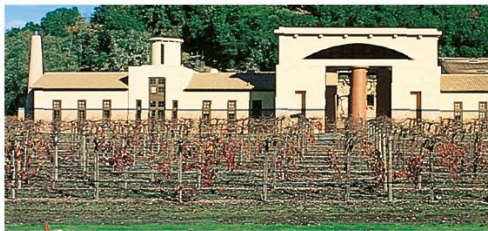


USA: West

THE ROCKY MOUNTAINS separate the coastal region from the drier inland states. Large and fast-growing cities such as San Francisco, Los Angeles, and San Diego hug the Pacific coast, and have attracted many migrants because of good job opportunities. Inland, blazing desert and towering mountains provide some of the most dramatic landscapes in the country. National parks such as Yellowstone in northwestern Wyoming and Montana and Yosemite in central California protect some of these wilderness areas. Further east, the foothills of the Rockies give way to vast plains grazed by large herds of cattle.



NORTHERN FORESTS
The coastal areas of Oregon and Washington contain large forests. These produce economically important timber, but much land is also left in its natural state and is popular with hikers. Most people here live in large cities like Seattle, and in the fertile inland valleys.



CALIFORNIA AGRICULTURE
California is warm, fertile, and, with irrigation, ideal for agriculture. Grapes are an important crop north of San Francisco in the Napa Valley. Further south, citrus crops such as oranges also flourish. Premium farming land is under threat, however, as the population expands.

The American Indian name for Death Valley is Tomesha, which means "land where the ground is on fire."



LOS ANGELES
This sprawling city—the second largest in the USA—is home to migrants from all over the world, as well as from other states in the country. Sandwiched between the coast and the mountains, the city has massive air pollution problems. This mostly arises from the exhaust fumes from the high number of cars used by commuters on the city's highways.